Chapter 6

Life Processes

- nutrition in plants -

1. What is photosynthesis?

It is the process by which green plants make their own food using sunlight, water and carbon dioxide from the air.

$6CO_2 + 6H_2O + \text{light energy} \rightarrow C_6H_{12}O_6 + 6O_2$

This happens inside the chloroplast.

Chlorophyll is the green pigment that traps the light energy needed for this reaction

2. Where does it happen?

* Chloroplast - the kitchen of the cell
* Thylakoid - light reaction here
* Stroma - Calvin cycle here
* Stomata - gas exchange (CO_2 in, O_2 out)

Remember: plants also respire, day and night.

3. Diagram: flow of energy

